

SPACE PHANTOM

FIRST APPEARANCE Avengers #2 (November 1963)**REAL NAME** Unknown **OCCUPATION** Agent of Immortus**BASE** Limbo **HEIGHT** 6 ft 6 in **WEIGHT** 215 lbs **EYES** Blue**HAIR** Red **SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES** Space Phantom can change his appearance to look like any living being. If they have superpowers, then he assumes those powers as well. The being whose form is taken is instantly sent to the dimension of Limbo.

Space Phantom is an alien from the planet Phantus, which shifted into the timeless dimension of Limbo when the space-time continuum ruptured. Stranded in Limbo, Space Phantom met IMMORTUS, the master of that realm. Immortus offered to free Space Phantom if he brought him beings to study. When Space Phantom agreed, Immortus gave him the power to assume the form of any being as a way to bring him subjects. When Space Phantom took on the form of another being, it was immediately sent to Limbo for Immortus to examine. On the occasion when Space Phantom tried to send the Thunder God, THOR, into Limbo, he was stopped and sent back into the timeless dimension. **MT**



SPEED

FIRST APPEARANCE Young Avengers #10 (February 2006)**REAL NAME** Thomas Shepherd**OCCUPATION** Adventurer **BASE** New York City**HEIGHT** 5 ft 10 in **WEIGHT** 182 lbs **EYES** Blue **HAIR** White**SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES** Superhuman speed, plus atomic destabilization, which can cause touched objects to explode.

Tommy Shepherd thought he'd been born and raised in New Jersey to Frank and Mary Shepherd. In fact, he and Billy Kaplan (*see* WICCAN) of the YOUNG AVENGERS were products of the SCARLET WITCH's powers. Desperate for children, the Scarlet Witch had created twin boys for herself out of lost souls, but MEPHISTO eventually came to reclaim them. When the Scarlet Witch remade the world on M-Day, she remade the boys too, placing them in different homes. Soon after the VISION and SUPER-SKRULL had figured this out,

Tommy took the codename Speed and joined his twin brother Billy in the Young Avengers. **MF**



SPEEDFREEK

FIRST APPEARANCE Incredible Hulk Vol. 2 #388 (December 1991)**REAL NAME** Leon Shappe**OCCUPATION** Assassin **BASE** Mobile**HEIGHT/WEIGHT** Unrevealed **EYES** Brown **HAIR** Brown**SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES** Combat suit of titanium steel alloy that is virtually indestructible; rocket-powered boots enable flight and travel at 150 mph; uses two long adamantium blades.

Drug addict Leon Shappe stole a sophisticated combat suit from an inventor and became the assassin Speedfreak. He clashed with the HULK a few times. When a protestor erroneously gunned down Shappe's daughter outside an abortion clinic, the Hulk stopped him from murdering the killer. While dodging Speedfreak's blades, the Hulk threw a car battery at him. Speedfreak



sliced right through it with his blades, accidentally showering himself with battery acid. He was part of the band of villains the New Warriors were battling in Stamford, Connecticut, when Nitro destroyed the place. Speedfreak died in the blast. **AD, MF**

SPEEDBALL

FIRST APPEARANCE Amazing Spider-Man Annual #22 (1988)**REAL NAME** Robert Baldwin **OCCUPATION** High-school student**BASE** New York City, formerly Springdale, Connecticut**HEIGHT** 5 ft 6 in **WEIGHT** 133 lbs **EYES** Blue **HAIR** Blond**SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES** Personal force-field allows him to absorb all kinetic energy directed at him and reflect it back at a greater velocity, which he often does by bouncing off objects.

Bombarded with energy bubbles from another dimension, Robert Baldwin gained strange powers. Once he learned to control them, he created a costume and took the name Speedball, becoming a crimefighter in his hometown. He co-founded the NEW WARRIORS and was with them when NITRO exploded, destroying a city and launching the Civil War (*see* pp. 84-5). Surviving Nitro's blast, Baldwin joined the THUNDERBOLTS, calling himself Penance and donning a suit of armor with 612 internal spikes, one for everyone who died in the explosion. He brought Nitro to justice, but recently MOONSTONE secretly drugged him and had him committed. **TD, MF**



SPEED DEMON

FIRST APPEARANCE Amazing Spider-Man Vol. 1 #222 (Nov. 1981)**REAL NAME** James Sanders**OCCUPATION** Professional criminal **BASE** New York City**HEIGHT** 5 ft 11 in **WEIGHT** 175 lbs **EYES** Black **HAIR** Gray**SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES** A super speedster, able to run at up to 160 mph; also possesses superhuman strength.

The GRANDMASTER gave James Sanders his powers when he recruited the chemist for his Squadron Sinister. Sanders called himself the Whizzer at first, but then changed it to Speed Demon instead. He regularly fought SPIDER-MAN and later joined the SINISTER SYNDICATE. After that, he took up with BARON VON STRUCKER'S THUNDERBOLTS, but he returned to the Sinister Squadron when the Grandmaster called him again. Under the Grandmaster's command, the team transformed into Supreme Power, and Speed Demon nearly helped them find the Wellspring of Power, but the Thunderbolts stopped him. **DW, MF**



SPHINX

FIRST APPEARANCE Nova Vol. 3 #6 (October 1999)**REAL NAME** Anath-Na Mut**OCCUPATION** Wizard **BASE** Mobile flying pyramid**HEIGHT** 7 ft 2 in **WEIGHT** 450 lbs **EYES** Red **HAIR** None**SPECIAL POWERS/ABILITIES** Enhanced strength; Ka stone permitted immortality, flight, telepathy, energy transference, and the ability to fire concussive beams.

Anath-Na Mut, an ancient Egyptian mutant given further powers by the Caretaker of Arcturus, served in the court of Ramses II until his failure to defeat Moses branded him an exile. He became the immortal Sphinx through the energies of the Ka stone, wandering for five thousand years until absorbing the extraterrestrial Xandar living computer with unwitting help from the hero NOVA. Now nearly omnipotent, the Sphinx met defeat at GALACTUS' hands. Later, Anath-Na Mut returned to life. When he merged with his reincarnated Egyptian lover, Meryet Karim (Sphinx II), the two formed the "Omni-Sphinx." **DW**

